

TidyTuesday Week 31

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Thursday 30th July, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back, dear reader, to the only weekly newsletter brave enough to shove two economic time series into a blender and describe the resulting smoothie as "science." As always, the machine picked these pairings at random, meaning any relationship you see below has roughly the same epistemic standing as a horoscope. Let us proceed with the appropriate mixture of enthusiasm and shame.

Monday, July 27, gave us the crossover episode nobody demanded: the World Pandemic Uncertainty Index for New Zealand versus U.S. private construction spending on communication infrastructure. The result? Absolutely nothing. An R-squared of 0.008, which is statistics-speak for "these two series have never met and would not recognize each other at a party." The p-value strolled in at 0.32, the detrended version somehow did even worse, and I, for one, am relieved. New Zealand's pandemic anxieties are not, it turns out, secretly wiring up America's phone lines. Sleep easy.

Then came the drama. Tuesday, July 28, paired a Northeast urban core-inflation index against the CPI for transportation services, and the raw regression posted an R-squared of 0.97 with a p-value so small it needs scientific notation to fit on the page. "Aha," you cry, "a trend mirage, the house special!" And normally you'd be right – but hold onto your spreadsheets, because when we stripped out the shared time trend, the detrended version still clocked an R-squared of 0.84 and a p-value with twenty-three zeros hiding behind the decimal. This is the rare, genuinely-interesting-looking result: two different price indexes moving together even after we remove the "everything gets more expensive forever" component. Shocking twist – inflation correlates with inflation. Alert the Nobel committee. This is the closest thing to a real relationship this project has stumbled into in weeks, and it feels deeply weird to admit it.

Wednesday, July 29, tried the same trick and got humbled. "Other Goods and Services" CPI versus a medical services price index looked gorgeous raw (R-squared 0.98!), and then the detrending machine walked in and reduced the relationship to a p-value of 0.97 and an R-squared of 0.00005 – a collapse so total it's almost artistic. Textbook trend mirage: two things that both go up over time, holding hands only because time exists. Thursday closed us out with government employment-and-training benefits versus a discontinued bank loan rate, which produced nothing raw but a faintly significant negative wiggle once detrended (p around 0.04). I'd love to theorize, but with an R-squared of 0.22 and a series that literally has "DISCONTINUED" in its name, I think the responsible move is to gently pretend it didn't happen. As ever: these are random pairings, no causal claims are being made, and if you take investment advice from this newsletter

that is a decision you made entirely on your own.

2 Date: 2026-07-27

Series ID: WUPINZL

This series is titled World Pandemic Uncertainty Index for New Zealand and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: PRCMUCON

This series is titled Total Private Construction Spending: Communication in the United States and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1993-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PRCMUCON	R-squared:	0.008
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.000
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.9862
Date:	Mon, 27 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.323
Time:	14:06:59	Log-Likelihood:	-897.76
No. Observations:	121	AIC:	1800.
Df Residuals:	119	BIC:	1805.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	1632.8538	37.497	43.547	0.000	1558.607	1707.101
value_fred_WUPINZL	10.4150	10.487	0.993	0.323	-10.351	31.181

Omnibus:	3.754	Durbin-Watson:	0.365
Prob(Omnibus):	0.153	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.215
Skew:	0.059	Prob(JB):	0.330
Kurtosis:	2.348	Cond. No.	3.63

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

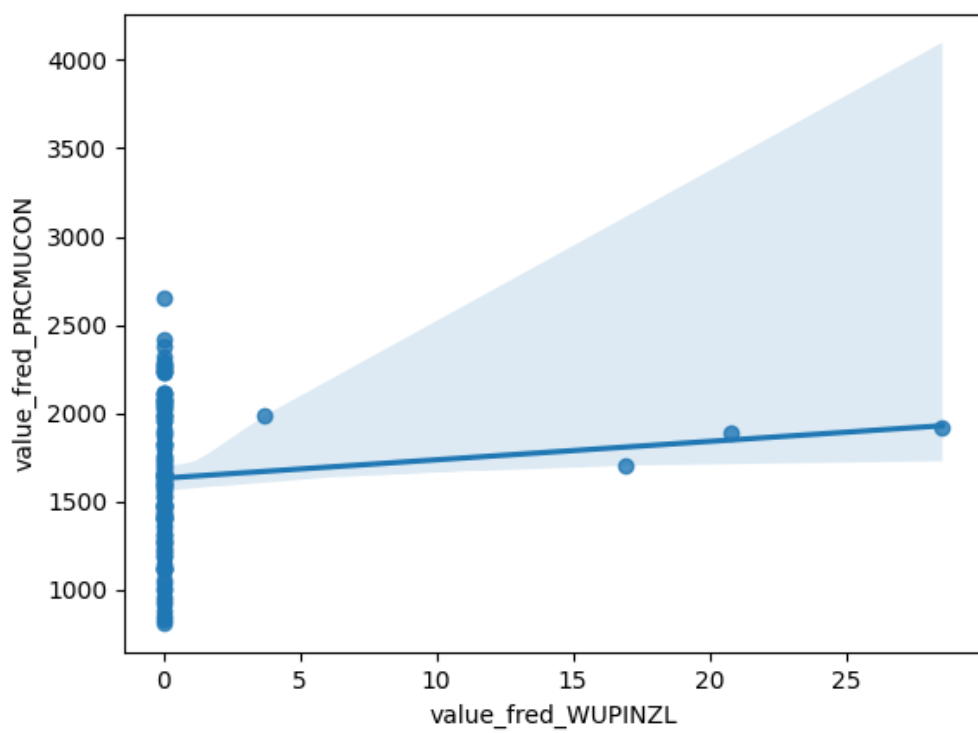


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-27

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PRCMUCON_detrended	R-squared:	0.005
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.5697
Date:	Mon, 27 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.452
Time:	14:06:59	Log-Likelihood:	-858.73
No. Observations:	121	AIC:	1721.
Df Residuals:	119	BIC:	1727.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.119e-11	26.801	4.17e-13	1.000	-53.069	53.069
value_fred_WUPINZL_detrended	-5.8542	7.756	-0.755	0.452	-21.212	9.503

Omnibus:	14.526	Durbin-Watson:	0.687
Prob(Omnibus):	0.001	Jarque-Bera (JB):	17.629
Skew:	0.701	Prob(JB):	0.000149
Kurtosis:	4.238	Cond. No.	3.46

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

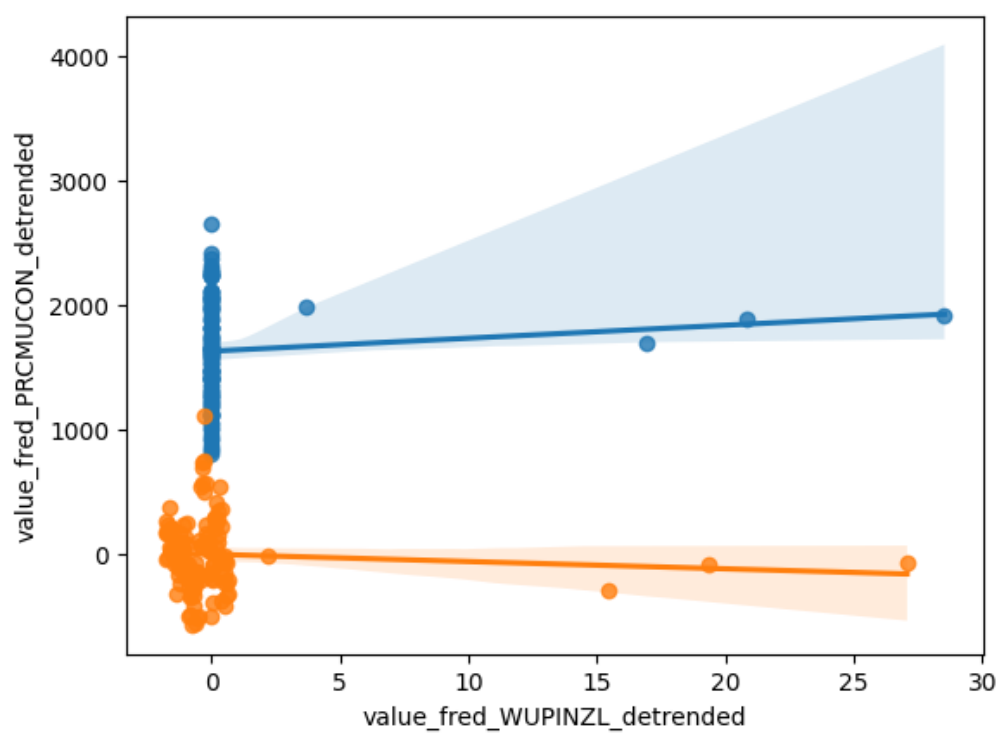


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-27

3 Date: 2026-07-28

Series ID: CUUSX100SA0L1E

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: All Items Less Food and Energy in Northeast - Size Class B/C and has a frequency of Semiannual. The units are Index Dec 1997=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1998-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: CWSR0000SAS4

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers: Transportation Services in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 1982-1984=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1956-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CWSR0000SAS4	R-squared:	0.974
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.973
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2037.
Date:	Tue, 28 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.80e-45
Time:	13:25:41	Log-Likelihood:	-227.11
No. Observations:	57	AIC:	458.2
Df Residuals:	55	BIC:	462.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-174.8164	10.353	-16.886	0.000	-195.564	-154.069
value_fred_CUUSX100SA0L1E	3.3910	0.075	45.134	0.000	3.240	3.542

Omnibus:	1.760	Durbin-Watson:	0.172
Prob(Omnibus):	0.415	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.997
Skew:	0.247	Prob(JB):	0.607
Kurtosis:	3.420	Cond. No.	813.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

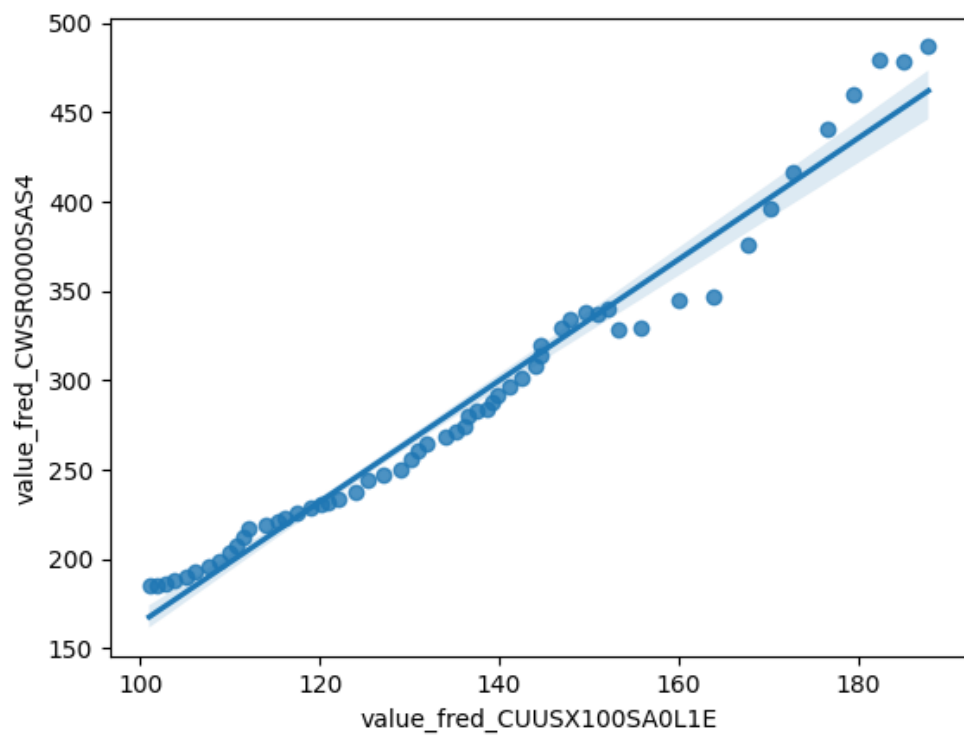


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-28

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CWSR0000SAS4_detrended	R-squared:	0.841
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.838
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	290.1
Date:	Tue, 28 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.35e-23
Time:	13:25:41	Log-Likelihood:	-212.21
No. Observations:	57	AIC:	428.4
Df Residuals:	55	BIC:	432.5
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.098e-11	1.350	-8.13e-12	1.000	-2.706	2.706
value_fred_CUUSX100SA0L1E_detrended	5.2535	0.308	17.033	0.000	4.635	5.872

Omnibus:	3.612	Durbin-Watson:	0.292
Prob(Omnibus):	0.164	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.762
Skew:	-0.345	Prob(JB):	0.251
Kurtosis:	3.828	Cond. No.	4.38

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

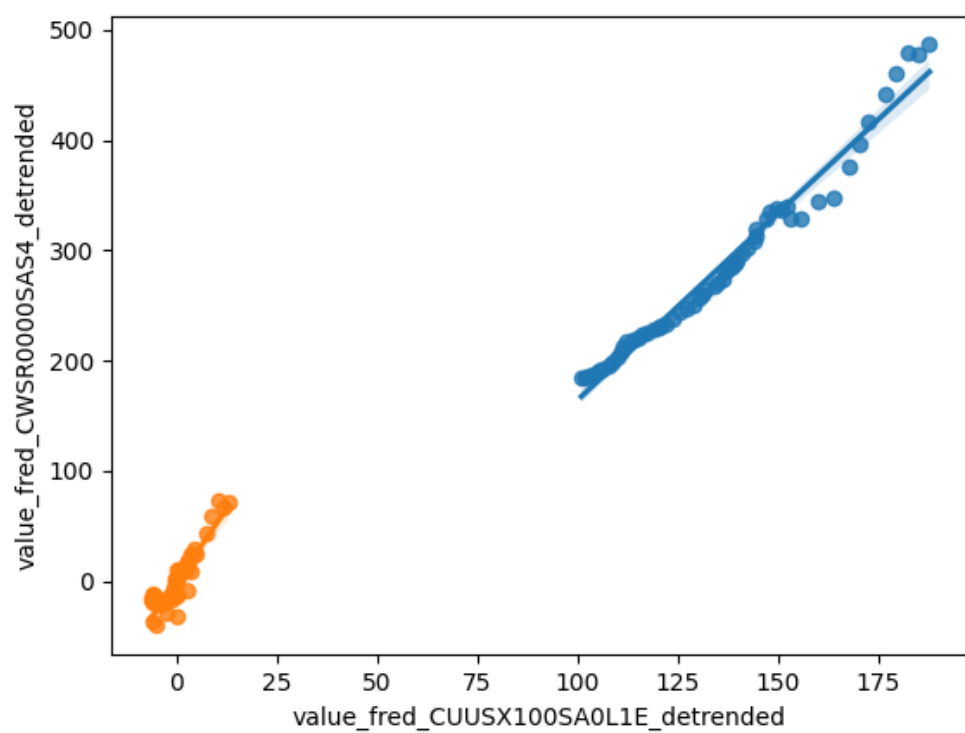


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-28

4 Date: 2026-07-29

Series ID: CWUR0000SAG

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers: Other Goods and Services in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 1982-1984=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1967-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: MESEPRPIHCSA

This series is titled Medical Services Expenditures by Provider Price Index and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2017=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2021-01-01. The popularity of this series is 3.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_MESEPRPIHCSA	R-squared:	0.981			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.980			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1020.			
Date:	Wed, 29 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.23e-18			
Time:	13:34:17	Log-Likelihood:	-48.503			
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	101.0			
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	103.2			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.9487	2.574	1.923	0.069	-0.421	10.318
value_fred_CWUR0000SAG	0.2061	0.006	31.936	0.000	0.193	0.220
Omnibus:	3.514	Durbin-Watson:	0.519			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.173	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.938			
Skew:	0.861	Prob(JB):	0.230			
Kurtosis:	2.512	Cond. No.	2.09e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

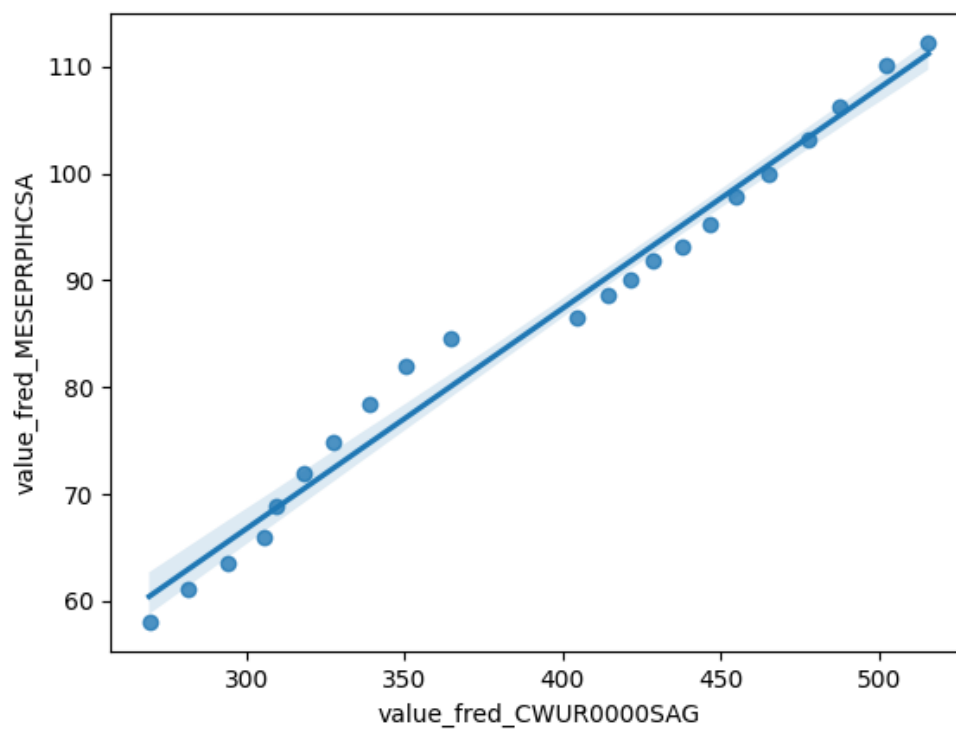


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-29

[2] The condition number is large, $2.09\text{e}+03$. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_MESEPRPIHCSA_detrended	R-squared:	0.000
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.050
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.001018
Date:	Wed, 29 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.975
Time:	13:34:17	Log-Likelihood:	-38.006
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	80.01
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	82.19
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.002e-12	0.304	3.29e-12	1.000	-0.635	0.635
value_fred_CWUR0000SAG_detrended	-0.0012	0.037	-0.032	0.975	-0.078	0.076

Omnibus:	2.786	Durbin-Watson:	0.239
Prob(Omnibus):	0.248	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.903
Skew:	0.527	Prob(JB):	0.386
Kurtosis:	2.018	Cond. No.	8.25

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

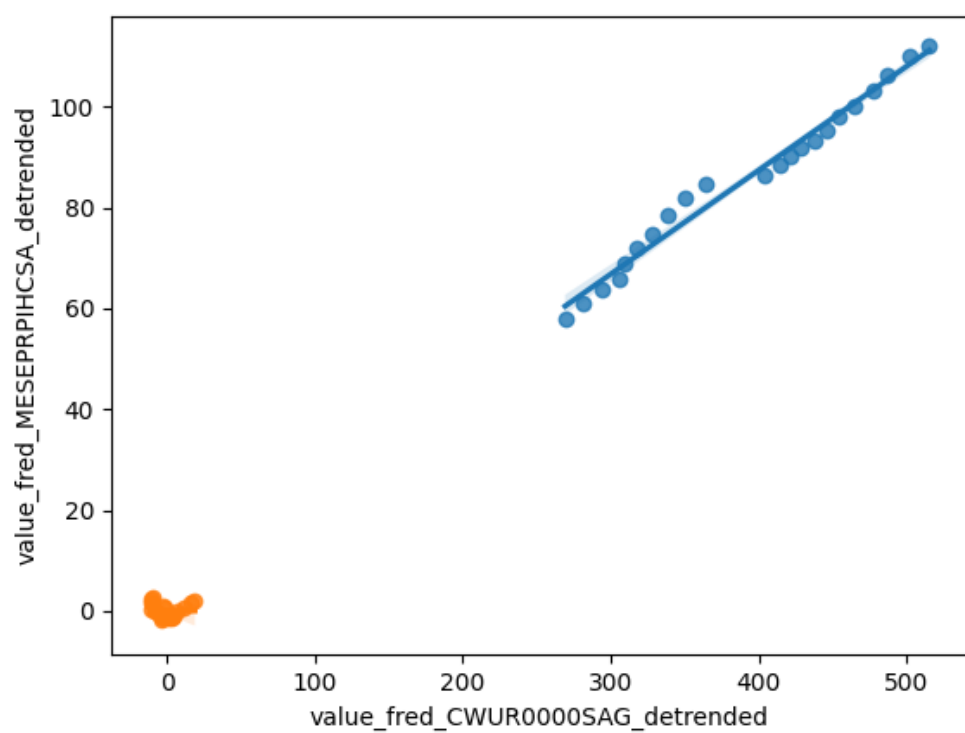


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-29

5 Date: 2026-07-30

Series ID: B1604C1A027NBEA

This series is titled Government social benefits: to persons: State and local: Employment and training and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1974-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EEZOXSLNQ

This series is titled Weighted-Average Effective Loan Rate for Zero Interval, Other Risk (Acceptable), Large Domestic Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-04-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EEZOXSLNQ	R-squared:	0.004
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.052
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.06894
Date:	Thu, 30 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.796
Time:	13:21:13	Log-Likelihood:	-43.377
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	90.75
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	92.75
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.8395	3.093	1.565	0.135	-1.659	11.338
value_fred_B1604C1A027NBEA	0.6756	2.573	0.263	0.796	-4.730	6.081

Omnibus:	4.642	Durbin-Watson:	0.457
Prob(Omnibus):	0.098	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.646
Skew:	0.672	Prob(JB):	0.266
Kurtosis:	1.830	Cond. No.	12.5

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

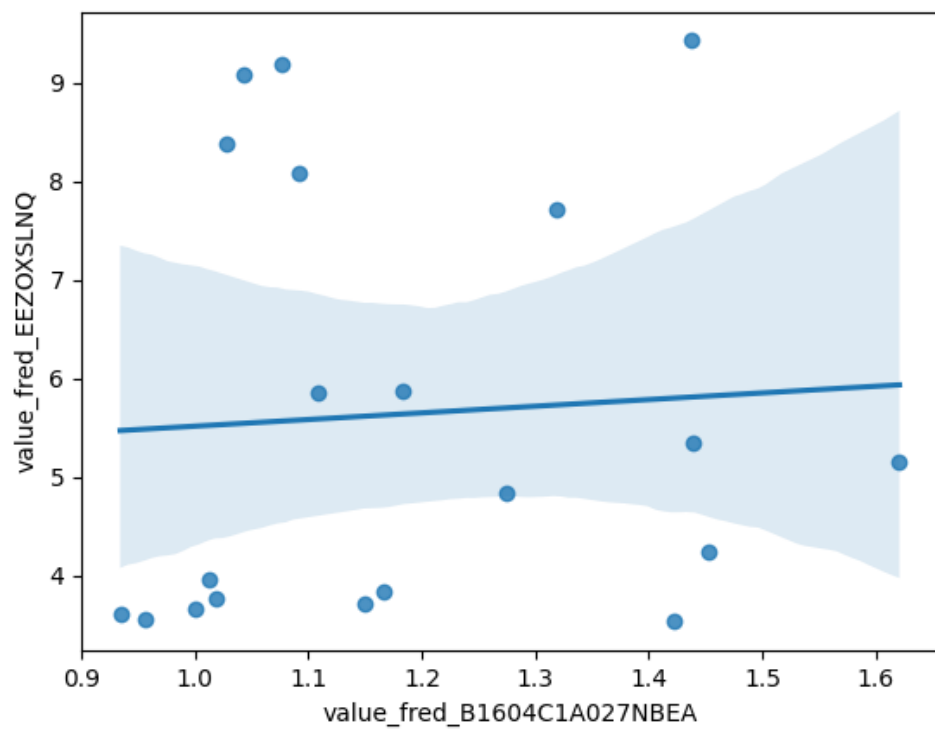


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-30

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EEZOXSLNQ_detrended	R-squared:	0.217
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.174
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	5.003
Date:	Thu, 30 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0382
Time:	13:21:13	Log-Likelihood:	-30.359
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	64.72
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	66.71
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	3.395e-13	0.260	1.3e-12	1.000	-0.547	0.547
value_fred_B1604C1A027NBEA_detrended	-3.2585	1.457	-2.237	0.038	-6.319	-0.198

Omnibus:	3.290	Durbin-Watson:	1.383
Prob(Omnibus):	0.193	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.475
Skew:	0.851	Prob(JB):	0.290
Kurtosis:	2.731	Cond. No.	5.60

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

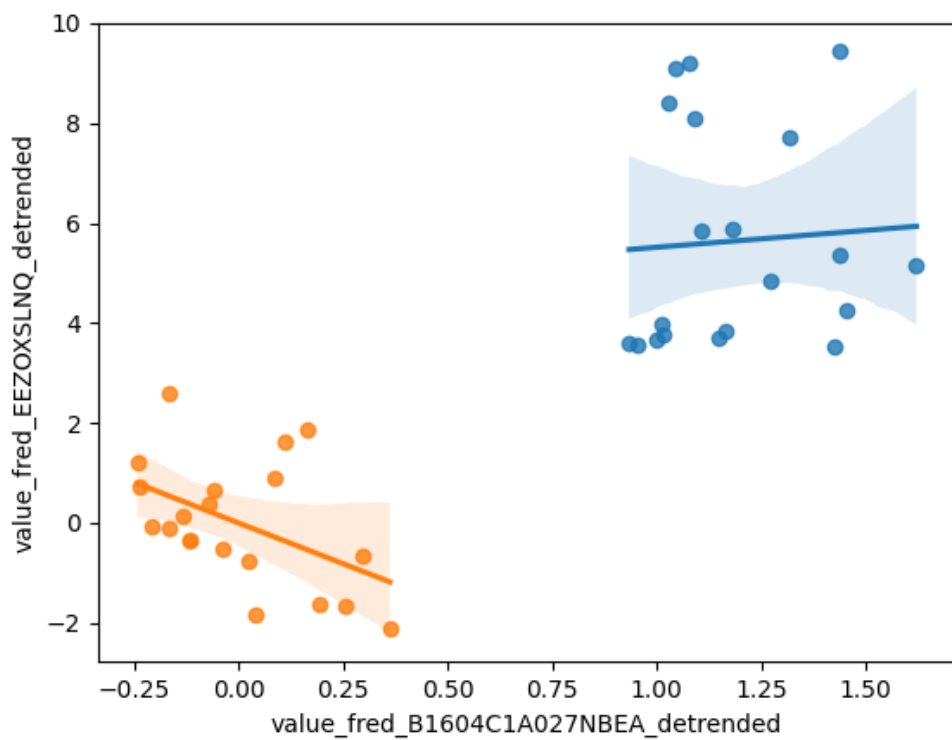


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-30